AXSS Axis Security Solutions

Career Services

CLIENT RESOURCE

Job Application Tracker

A complete guide to logging your applications, understanding your tailoring scores, and using your data in coaching sessions to land interviews faster.

For: All AS Solutions clients in active job search
Pairs with: AS Solutions Job Application Tracker (HTML file)
Version: 2026 Edition

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SECTION 01

Why this tracker exists

Most job seekers apply to positions and then wait. When nothing happens, they either apply to more roles or go quiet. Without a record of what they submitted, how they tailored the resume, or which platforms they used, there is no way to diagnose why applications are not converting to interviews and no data to act on.

Your AS Solutions Job Application Tracker solves that problem. It creates a running record of every application you make, how well you tailored your resume for each one, what happened afterward, and what patterns explain your results. Every piece of data you enter becomes something your consultant can use in your coaching sessions to give you specific, evidence-based guidance rather than generic advice.

Research across industries consistently shows that candidates who apply to 8-12 well-targeted, well-tailored roles per week land their first interview within 30-45 days. Sporadic or untailored applications take months longer or produce no results at all.

> 🎯 The **tracker's core purpose in one sentence It** turns your job search from a guessing game into a measurable process your consultant can actively improve with you.

SECTION 02

Getting started

Opening the tracker

Your AS Solutions consultant will send you the tracker as a single HTML file with a .html file extension. Save it to your computer or cloud storage such as Google Drive, Dropbox, or iCloud. To open it, double-click the file and it will open directly in your web browser. Chrome, Edge, Firefox, and Safari all work. No installation, no account, and no internet connection is required after the first open.

> 💾 Your **data saves automatically. Everything** you enter is saved privately to your browser on your device. If you open the file on a different computer, you will start fresh. Keep the file in one consistent location. A cloud drive is ideal so you can access it from multiple devices without losing data.

The demo data

When you first open the tracker, you will see sample applications for a fictional client named John Doe. These are pre-loaded to show you how the tracker looks when it is in use.

The four tabs

Dashboard	**Your home view.** Shows your five most recent applications, five performance stats, a weekly application cadence chart, and your 30-day progress toward the application volume target.
Application Log	**Your full searchable history.** Every application you have ever logged, filterable by status and tailoring score.
Timeline	**Chronological view with details.** Each application shown as a card with its tailoring score, notes, keywords, resume version, and status history.

Coaching View

Session-ready analytics. Conversion funnel, tailoring score distribution, application sources, and behavioral insights for use during AS Solutions coaching sessions.

Fig. 1 - Dashboard tab

AXSS Axis Security Solutions | Dashboard Application Log Timeline Coaching View

TOTAL APPLIED	RESPONSES	INTERVIEWS	AVG TAILORING	STRONG TAILORS
4	**2**	**0**	**63%**	**2**
all time	50% response rate	secured	of 4 scored	70%+ score

ROLE / COMPANY	DATE	TAILORING SCORE	SOURCE	DAYS	STATUS
Incident Response Analyst Mandiant (Google) - Remote	May 2, 2026	**Strong 100%**	Company Site	10d	**Applied**
Security Operations Analyst Leidos - Reston, VA (Hybrid)	Apr 22, 2026	**Moderate 46%**	Indeed	20d	**No response**
SOC Analyst I CrowdStrike - Remote	Apr 20, 2026	**Strong 88%**	LinkedIn	22d	**Phone screen**
Cybersecurity Analyst SAIC - Chantilly, VA	Apr 18, 2026	**Weak 16%**	ClearanceJobs	24d	**Rejected**

The five stat cards show total applied, responses, interviews, average tailoring score, and strong tailors. The application table shows each role with its tailoring score badge, status, and days outstanding.

SECTION 03

Logging your first application

Click the **+ Log Application** button on any tab to open the application form. Fill in each field as completely as you can. The more detail you enter, the more useful your data is in coaching sessions.

Fig. 2 - Log Application form

Log application

Fill in the details for this application. The tailoring scorecard will calculate your match quality.

ROLE TITLE *	COMPANY *
e.g. SOC Analyst I	e.g. Palo Alto Networks

JOB POSTING URL	LOCATION / REMOTE
https://...	e.g. Atlanta, GA / Remote

DATE APPLIED *	JOB BOARD / SOURCE	PLATFORM SUBMITTED ON
05 / 13 / 2026	Select	Select

KEYWORDS ADDED TO RESUME

e.g. project management, stakeholder communication, budget oversight

GENERAL TAILORING NOTES

Describe any changes you made to your resume for this specific role...

Tailoring Scorecard

Check every action you actually completed before submitting

0 / 100 PTS

KEYWORD ALIGNMENT **35 pts**

- ☐ Pulled 8-12 keywords directly from the job description **+10**
- ☐ Added missing keywords naturally into experience bullet points **+10**
- ☐ Verified keywords appear in the Skills / Competencies section **+8**
- ☐ Matched exact phrasing from the JD (e.g. "project management" not "PM") **+7**

The Tailoring Scorecard at the bottom updates your score in real time as you check each item. Work through the full checklist before clicking Save Application.

1

Role title and company

Enter the exact role title as it appears in the job posting, not a shortened version. Exact titles let you track patterns across what types of roles are or are not converting for you.

2

Job posting URL

Paste the full URL of the job posting. Many postings expire within a few weeks. Copy the job description text into a separate document if it is a strong target so you have it for reference even after the posting disappears.

3

Date applied

This auto-fills to today's date. Log applications the same day you submit them. The date is used to calculate how long applications have been outstanding and to generate your weekly cadence chart.

4

Job board and platform

Select where you found the role and where you actually submitted the application. A role found on LinkedIn might be submitted through the company's own Workday system. A platform hint will appear when you select. Read it, especially for Workday and LinkedIn Easy Apply.

5

Keywords added

List the specific keywords you added to your resume for this application, separated by commas. For example: project management, stakeholder communication, budget oversight for a PM role; or data analysis, SQL, dashboard development for an analytics role.

6

Tailoring notes

Write a brief description of what you changed in your resume. Be honest and specific. "Applied general resume" tells your consultant this application did not get your full tailoring effort.

7

Tailoring Scorecard

Work through the checklist and check every item you completed before submitting. Your score updates live. Covered in detail in Section 04.

8

Resume version used

Click the upload zone to select the resume file you submitted. The filename is recorded but the actual document is not uploaded to any server. It stays on your device.

SECTION 04

The Tailoring Scorecard

The Tailoring Scorecard is the most important feature in the tracker. It measures how thoroughly you tailored your resume for a specific role before submitting. Not whether you have the right qualifications, but whether your resume communicated those qualifications in the language the employer's hiring system and recruiter are looking for.

Every application is scored out of 100 points across four categories. The score appears on your application cards, in your dashboard stats, in the coaching view, and in your exported PDF reports.

Strong - 70 to 100%	Moderate - 40 to 69%	Weak - below 40%

⚠️ **What the data shows across AS Solutions clients** Applications scoring below 40% rarely advance past ATS screening. Applications scoring 70% or above consistently outperform lower-scored submissions even when the candidate's background is comparable. The score gap explains most of the "I applied to 50 roles and heard nothing" situations.

Score breakdown - what each category measures

Checklist Item	Why it matters	Pts
Keyword Alignment	**35 pts**	
Pulled 8-12 keywords directly from the job description	ATS systems score resumes by counting matches to JD terms. If you do not pull the actual terms, you are guessing at what the system is looking for.	10
Added missing keywords naturally into experience bullets	Keywords only in a Skills section are penalized by many ATS platforms. Keywords in context carry more weight than isolated lists.	10
Verified keywords appear in Skills / Competencies section	Recruiters scan Skills as a fast checklist. A missing priority term from the JD means failing the 30-second screen.	8
Matched exact phrasing from the JD (e.g. "project management" not "PM")	ATS systems often do exact-string matching. Mirror the posting's exact phrasing at least once. Do not paraphrase.	7
Summary & Positioning	**20 pts**	
Updated the resume summary to name the target role specifically	Your summary should open with the exact role you are applying for.	8

	A generic summary fails the recruiter's first question.	
Summary reflects the experience level and seniority in the JD	Entry-level and senior JD language are different. Mismatched register signals a resume not written for this role.	7
Removed or deprioritized experience irrelevant to this role	Irrelevant content wastes ATS scoring weight. Move it lower so relevant content leads.	5
Bullets & Accomplishments	**25 pts**	
Rewrote at least 3 bullets to mirror language or priorities from the JD	Find the JD's top 3 responsibilities and make sure 3 of your bullets directly address each one in JD language.	10
Added or updated quantified metrics relevant to the role	Numbers that match what the employer cares about make outcomes concrete and credible. Generic bullets read as filler.	8
Removed filler bullets that do not connect to the JD requirements	If a bullet does not speak to this role, it wastes space and dilutes your ATS relevance signal.	7
Submission Quality	**20 pts**	
Applied through the company's own ATS when possible (not LinkedIn Easy Apply)	Company ATS applications parse your resume directly. Easy Apply compresses submissions and loses keyword fidelity.	8
Saved resume in the correct format for the target platform	DOCX for Workday and Taleo. Text-based PDF elsewhere. Wrong format causes parsing failures. See Section 05.	5
Read the full job description before applying	Reading the full JD makes targeted tailoring possible and separates the careful applicant from the spray-and-pray one.	4
Proofread the resume after editing for tailoring errors	A paste error or scrambled bullet introduced during editing can cost you an interview.	3

✅ How **to use the scorecard honestly:** Only check items you actually completed. The scorecard is not a test you pass by checking every box. It is a diagnostic tool. An honest 42% score that leads to a real conversation in your coaching session is more valuable than a dishonest 100% that hides the actual reason your applications are not converting.

SECTION 05

File format - which file type to submit

File format is not a universal rule. It is platform specific. Submitting the wrong format for a specific platform can cause your experience timeline to scramble, your keywords to detach from your job titles, or your entire resume to fail to parse. The tracker will show you a platform hint when you select where you submitted.

Platform	Required Format	Why it matters
Workday	**DOCX required**	Workday's parser can misalign PDF date fields, causing experience durations to calculate incorrectly and affecting your ranking score. Use DOCX unless the posting explicitly says otherwise.
Taleo (Oracle)	**DOCX required**	Taleo is the most parser-sensitive of all major ATS platforms. Tables, multi-column layouts, headers/footers, and PDFs all cause field extraction failures. DOCX with a clean single-column layout is the only safe choice.
Greenhouse	**PDF (text-based)**	Text-based PDF is fine. Greenhouse does not use AI to fill keyword gaps. If a skill is not on the page with exact JD phrasing, you will not be tagged for it.
Lever	**PDF (text-based)**	PDF is fine. Lever links all your submissions into one unified profile. Keep job titles and core keywords consistent across every version you submit.
iCIMS	**PDF (text-based)**	PDF is fine. iCIMS uses semantic matching and weights the top third of page one heavily. Front-load your summary and first two bullets with your strongest keywords.
LinkedIn Easy Apply	**Avoid if possible**	LinkedIn Easy Apply compresses your resume during submission and often loses formatting and keyword fidelity. Go directly to the company's website and apply through their own ATS instead whenever possible.
Email submission	**PDF + DOCX**	Send both when the posting does not specify. DOCX lets the recruiter edit if needed. PDF preserves formatting exactly. Name the file: FirstName_LastName_RoleTarget_Resume with no spaces or special characters.
Never submit	**Scanned PDF**	A scanned or image-based PDF produces zero extractable text for any ATS system. Every parser on every platform will fail to read it. Always submit a natively created text-based document.

SECTION 06

Updating application status over time

Logging an application is the beginning. Keeping it updated is what makes the tracker useful over time. Every time something happens with an application, open the detail view and click **Update Status**.

Status options and what they mean

Applied	Under Review	Phone Screen	Interview	Offer	Rejected	No Response

The status history feature

Every time you update a status, the tracker creates a timestamped history entry. Add a note to each update to record recruiter names, what was said in a screen, reasons given for rejection, or what happens next. Over time this audit trail becomes one of the most useful things you can bring to a coaching session.

> 📋 What **to write in status notes:** Recruiter name and company. What was said or written. Date of any scheduled event. Reason given for rejection if provided. What you are expected to do next. Even a single sentence per update is far better than leaving the note blank.

SECTION 07

Reading your dashboard

The five stats at the top

Total Applied	**All applications ever logged.** If this number is low and you have been searching for weeks, volume is the first problem to solve.
Responses	**Applications that received any non-rejection response.** A response rate below 10% typically points to an ATS problem. A rate above 10% with no interviews suggests a human review problem.
Interviews	**Applications at Interview Scheduled or Offer Received status.** This is the number your AS Solutions consultant is focused on helping you grow.
Avg Tailoring	**Your average tailoring scorecard score across all scored applications.** If it is below 50%, improving tailoring discipline is the highest-leverage action available to you.
Strong Tailors	**Applications scoring 70% or above.** Study what you did on each of these and replicate that approach on every future submission.

Weekly cadence chart

Shows your application volume by week for the past six weeks. A consistent bar chart near or above 10 applications per week indicates a healthy search cadence. Gaps, spikes, or declining bars indicate an inconsistent search unlikely to produce the 30–45-day interview timeline.

30-day target progress bar

Tracks your application volume over the past 30 days against a target of 40 applications. Green means you are on track, amber means you are behind but recoverable, and red means the volume gap is significant enough to extend your timeline materially.

SECTION 08

The 30–45-day interview window

AS Solutions' 30–45-day interview target is not a guarantee. It is a benchmark that has been consistently achievable for clients who meet three specific conditions. Most clients who do not reach the benchmark are failing one of them, not all three.

3

CONDITIONS FOR THE 30-45 DAY WINDOW

Volume + Tailoring + Platform = Interview

Consistent weekly application volume (8-12 targeted roles), deliberate tailoring scoring 70% or above on the scorecard, and correct platform selection on every submission. All three conditions must be met simultaneously. Excelling at two while failing the third extends your timeline significantly.

What a strong application week looks like

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Research 5 target roles. Copy JDs to working doc.	Tailor resume for roles 1-2. Score on scorecard.	Submit roles 1-2. Tailor roles 3-4.	Submit roles 3-4. Research 3 more targets.	Tailor and submit roles 5-6. Log all apps. Update statuses.	Optional: research weekend postings.	Review week. Prep next targets.

🚫 **Two habits that extend your timeline by months: Applying sporadically (10 applications one week, none for two weeks)** breaks the pipeline that produces interview offers. **Applying the same general resume to every role without tailoring means** every application is competing at a fraction of its potential. Both habits are visible in your tracker data, which is exactly why logging honestly matters.

SECTION 09

Preparing for your coaching session

Your coaching sessions are most productive when you arrive with data. Before each session, spend five minutes doing the following:

- ☐ **Log all applications since your last session.** Even ones you submitted without much tailoring. Honest data is more useful than a curated log.

- [ ] **Update statuses on any applications that received responses.** Include notes on what was said, who reached out, and what happens next.

- [ ] **Open the Coaching View tab.** Review the behavioral insights section before your session so you can speak to the patterns your consultant will ask about.

- [ ] **Export a PDF report.** Click Export PDF, select all sections, enter today's date, and open the print preview. Print or save as PDF and bring it to the session.

- [ ] **Note any applications where you scored below 40%.** These are the ones your consultant will want to diagnose first. Think about what you did or did not do differently on those applications.

- [ ] **Identify your one strongest application this period.** The one you spent the most time tailoring and scored the highest. Your consultant will want to understand what made it different.

📊 If **you have not been getting responses:** Bring your tracker to your coaching session with an honest log even if it shows low volume, low tailoring scores, or inconsistent application habits. The data that shows what is going wrong is exactly what your consultant needs to help you fix it. Gaps in the log are data too.

SECTION 10

Frequently asked questions

Q: Does anyone at AS Solutions see my data?

A: No. All data you enter is saved only to your browser on your device. AS Solutions does not have access to your tracker unless you share it by exporting a PDF and sending it, or by showing it on screen during a session. Nothing is transmitted anywhere automatically.

Q: What if I apply to a role without tailoring? Should I still log it?

A: Yes, always log it honestly. Leave the scorecard items unchecked and note in the tailoring notes that you applied without tailoring. An honest log with low-scoring applications is more valuable than a log that only records your best submissions.

Q: How do I know if my tailoring score is good enough?

A: 70% or above is the target threshold. Below 70% means at least one category has significant gaps, typically keyword alignment (35 points) or bullet rewrites (25 points). Focus on those two categories first. They make up 60% of the possible score and have the most direct impact on ATS performance.

Q: I have been applying for months with no results. What does the tracker tell me to do?

A: Open the Coaching View and look at three numbers: your average tailoring score, the percentage of applications via LinkedIn Easy Apply versus Company ATS, and your weekly application volume. Average score below 50% means tailoring is the issue. Heavy LinkedIn Easy Apply use means platform is the issue. Fewer than 5 applications per week means volume is the issue. Bring these numbers to your next coaching session.

Q: The job posting expired. Can I still log the application?

A: Yes. Log it normally. You do not need a live URL. If you saved the job description text separately, note the key details in the tailoring notes field.

Q: What does "No Response" mean vs "Rejected"?

A: No Response means you submitted and received no communication at all. It often means the application did not clear ATS screening and was never reviewed by a human. Rejected means you received an explicit rejection message. No Response points toward an ATS problem. A post-screen rejection points toward a human review problem.

Q: Should I log every application or just my best ones?

A: Every application, including the ones you applied to quickly without much tailoring. The coaching view is designed to identify patterns across your full application history. Selective logging produces misleading data and misleading insights.

Q: My tracker data disappeared. What happened?

A: Data is saved to your browser's local storage on the specific device and browser you used. If you opened the tracker in a different browser, cleared your browser data, or opened the file from a different location, your previous data will not appear. Keep the file in a consistent location such as Google Drive or Dropbox and always open it in the same browser.

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